

years, he opened Rudolf's East and Rudolf's West, earning good reviews when his businesses were rated in the city newspapers. He opened Rudy's Bar & Grill when his oldest son finished college with a business degree and made him a partner as a graduation gift.

Rudy's second son was not interested in being a business owner, but he made a good living in medical supplies.

Penny came along several years after her brothers. Her life was busy with school, friends, a large extended family, and social activities with their Orthodox church. Each summer through her sophomore year of high school, she spent two weeks at a camp for children and youth of her ethnic upbringing, where they learned of their heritage, practiced dances, had conversational language lessons, and cooked.

Penny's parents did not expect her to attend college. They assumed she'd settle down with a boy from the church and happily create a new generation for the Balosek family tree. But after she and David had been dating for three years, they decided not to get married, to the disappointment of both families. Tired of her job in the grocery store, Penny took a course in data management through a technical school and went to work for a dental practice owned by a distant relative.

When she was twenty, she moved out of her parents' home into a town-house. Her parents gifted her with a down payment, believing it was wasteful to pay rent when she was able to invest in a property. She was excelling at her job and found she enjoyed it. Her take-home pay was plenty to cover the house payment, insurance, utilities, and even the expense of the new, heavily financed car she had chosen with her father's help.

She went shopping with her mother to furnish her new place. Penny had always paid off both of her credit cards in full each month, so she had plenty of available credit. She and her mother found reasonably priced but high-quality pieces to fill the living room and bedroom, and then purchased appliances and a large-screen TV. Penny wavered a bit when she figured up the total she